



CNIDARIANS

Members of the phylum Cnidaria are soft-bodied invertebrates that kill their prey with stinging cells. Of the 11,947 known species, the vast majority are marine.



FLATWORMS

Numbering about 30,000 species, the phylum Platyhelminthes contains animals with a flat, thin body, and a distinguishable head and tail.



SEGMENTED WORMS

With about 18,000 species, the phylum Annelida contains worms that have a sinuous body, which is divided into ring-like segments. It includes earthworms and leeches.

CRUSTACEANS

Mainly aquatic, crustaceans are arthropods that breathe with gills. Classified as the subphylum Crustacea, there are about 70,000 species, including crabs and lobsters.



MOLLUSCS

One of the most diverse invertebrate groups, the phylum Mollusca contains almost 72,000 species. It includes gastropods, bivalves, and cephalopods.



ECHINODERMS

Recognizable by their five-fold symmetry, members of the phylum Echinodermata have a skeleton of small, chalky plates set in their skin. There are about 7,450 species.

